

Word family: **misunderstand / misunderstands / misunderstood / misunderstanding / misunderstandings**

Base word: misunderstand

Part of speech: mainly **verb**

Related forms:

* **misunderstand** (v.) — 誤解；誤會

* **misunderstood** (past / past participle; adj.) — 誤解了；被誤解的

* **misunderstanding** (n.) — 誤會；誤解；誤解造成的不和

* **misunderstandings** (plural) — 多次誤會；不同誤解

Useful expressions / extensions:

* **misunderstand someone**

* **misunderstand what someone means**

* **be misunderstood**

* **completely misunderstand**

* **a misunderstanding between people**

* **a simple misunderstanding**

* **a serious misunderstanding**

* **clear up a misunderstanding**

* **avoid misunderstanding**

* **cause a misunderstanding**

* **due to a misunderstanding**

* **there seems to have been a misunderstanding**

* **don't misunderstand me**

* **if I've understood correctly / if I've misunderstood**

Meaning in this passage

> When people are under pressure, **misunderstandings** can happen in the blink of an eye...

Here, **misunderstandings** means:

situations where people understand a fact, message, action, or another person's intention incorrectly — 誤會；誤解

Kevin wrongly thought the speaker had failed to upload the slides, when in fact he had simply opened the wrong file.

中文翻譯：

當人處於壓力之下時，**誤會**可以在一瞬間發生。

So here:

misunderstanding = 因為理解錯誤而形成的錯誤判斷、錯誤印象或人際不和

1. **misunderstanding (誤會 ; 誤解) — 誤會 ; 誤解**

This is the exact sense used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> Under pressure, **misunderstandings** can happen very quickly.

人在壓力之下時，**誤會**可以很快發生。

Practice 2

> The argument started because of a **misunderstanding**.

那場爭吵是因為一場**誤會**開始的。

Practice 3

> It was all a **misunderstanding**.

整件事只是一場**誤會**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****misunderstanding = 因錯誤理解某件事、某句話或某人的意圖而形成的錯誤看法或情況****

2. **a misunderstanding between people — 人與人之間的誤會**

Practice 1

> There was a **misunderstanding between Kevin and me**.

Kevin 和我之間出現了一場**誤會**。

Practice 2

> A small **misunderstanding between teammates** caused unnecessary tension.

隊友之間一個小小的**誤會**造成了不必要的緊張。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****a misunderstanding between A and B = A 和 B 因理解不同而產生的誤會****

3. ****simple misunderstanding — 單純的誤會****

Practice 1

> It turned out to be a ****simple misunderstanding****.

最後發現只是一場****單純的誤會****。

Practice 2

> Nobody had done anything wrong; it was just a ****simple misunderstanding****.

其實沒有人做錯甚麼，只是一場****小誤會****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****simple misunderstanding = 沒有複雜惡意，只是單純因理解錯誤而產生的誤會****

4. ****serious misunderstanding — 嚴重誤會****

Practice 1

> The email caused a ****serious misunderstanding****.

那封電郵造成了一場****嚴重誤會****。

Practice 2

> A ****serious misunderstanding**** can damage trust.

一場****嚴重誤會****可以破壞信任。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****serious misunderstanding = 後果較大、可能影響關係或決定的誤會****

5. ****clear up a misunderstanding — 澄清誤會****

A very important collocation.

Practice 1

> We talked and ****cleared up the misunderstanding****.

我們談過後，****澄清了誤會****。

Practice 2

> His apology helped ****clear up the misunderstanding****.

他的道歉有助****化解 / 澄清誤會****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****clear up a misunderstanding = 解釋清楚事實，使原本的錯誤理解消失****

6. ****avoid misunderstanding — 避免誤會****

Practice 1

> Be specific to ****avoid misunderstanding****.

說清楚一點可以****避免誤會****。

Practice 2

> Written instructions can help ****avoid misunderstandings****.

書面說明可以幫助****避免誤解****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****avoid misunderstanding = 採取措施防止別人錯誤理解****

7. ****cause a misunderstanding — 引起誤會****

Practice 1

> His vague message ****caused a misunderstanding****.

他那個含糊的訊息**引起了誤會**。

Practice 2

> Poor communication can **cause misunderstandings**.

溝通不良可以**造成誤會**。

MCQ-ready definition:

cause a misunderstanding = 令別人形成錯誤理解

8. **due to a misunderstanding — 因為誤會**

Practice 1

> The delay happened **due to a misunderstanding**.

延誤是**因為一場誤會**造成的。

Practice 2

> He blamed me **due to a misunderstanding**.

他因為**誤會**而怪責我。

MCQ-ready definition:

due to a misunderstanding = 因為錯誤理解某件事而導致某結果

9. **There seems to have been a misunderstanding. — 看來出現了誤會**

A very useful polite formula.

Practice 1

> **There seems to have been a misunderstanding.**

看來我們之間有些誤會。

Practice 2

> I think **there has been a misunderstanding** about the deadline.

我想大家對截止日期**有些誤會**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****there has been a misunderstanding = 禮貌地表示雙方對某件事的理解不一致****

10. ****misunderstand someone — 誤解某人****

Verb sense.

Practice 1

> You ****misunderstood me****.

你****誤會我了****。

Practice 2

> I think Kevin ****misunderstood the situation****.

我想 Kevin ****誤解了情況****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****misunderstand someone/something = 對某人所說、所做或某個情況作出錯誤理解****

11. ****misunderstand what someone means — 誤解某人的意思****

Practice 1

> I ****misunderstood what he meant****.

我****誤解了他的意思****。

Practice 2

> She ****misunderstood my comment**** as criticism.

她把我的評論****誤解成批評****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****misunderstand what someone means = 錯誤理解某人的真正意思或意圖****

12. **completely misunderstand** — 完全誤解

Practice 1

> He had **completely misunderstood** what happened.

他**完全誤解了**事情的經過。

Practice 2

> I think you've **completely misunderstood me**.

我想你**完全誤會**我了。

MCQ-ready definition:

completely misunderstand = 對某件事作出非常錯誤的理解

13. **be misunderstood** — 被誤解

Practice 1

> I felt **misunderstood**.

我覺得自己**被人誤解**。

Practice 2

> Her intentions were **misunderstood**.

她的意圖被**誤解**了。

MCQ-ready definition:

be misunderstood = 別人沒有正確理解你的意思、行為或意圖

14. **misunderstood** (adj. : 被誤解的) — 被誤解的

Practice 1

> He felt like a **misunderstood person**.

他覺得自己是一個**常被誤解的人**。

Practice 2

> The character is often described as **misunderstood**.

這個角色常被形容為**被人誤解的**。

MCQ-ready definition:

misunderstood = 別人沒有真正理解其性格、動機或意思的

15. **Don't misunderstand me. — 別誤會我的意思**

A very useful discourse phrase.

Practice 1

> **Don't misunderstand me**—I'm not blaming you.

不要誤會我的意思，我不是在怪你。

Practice 2

> **Don't misunderstand me**; I agree with most of what you said.

別誤解我，其實你說的大部分我都同意。

MCQ-ready definition:

Don't misunderstand me = 提醒對方不要把自己的真正意思理解錯

16. **if I've misunderstood — 如果我理解錯了**

Practice 1

> Correct me **if I've misunderstood**.

如果我**理解錯了**，請糾正我。

Practice 2

> **If I've misunderstood**, please explain it again.

如果我**誤解了**，請再解釋一次。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****if I've misunderstood = 用來承認自己有可能錯誤理解資訊****

17. ****misunderstanding (對說話內容的誤解) — 理解錯誤****

Practice 1

> The instruction led to a ****misunderstanding**** about who should upload the file.

那個指示令人****誤解了誰應該上傳檔案****。

Practice 2

> There was a ****misunderstanding about the meeting time****.

大家對會議時間有一個****誤解****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****misunderstanding about X = 對 X 的具體資訊理解錯誤****

18. ****misunderstanding (人際上的不和 / 隔閡) — 誤會 ; 不和****

This can extend from the mistaken interpretation to the relationship tension it causes.

Practice 1

> The two friends had a ****misunderstanding**** and stopped speaking for a week.

兩個朋友因一場****誤會 / 不和****而一星期沒有說話。

Practice 2

> I hope this ****misunderstanding**** doesn't damage our friendship.

我希望這場****誤會****不會破壞我們的友誼。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****misunderstanding = 因理解錯誤而造成的人際緊張、爭執或隔閡****

19. **minor misunderstanding** — 小誤會

Practice 1

> It was only a **minor misunderstanding**.

那只是一場**小誤會**。

Practice 2

> A **minor misunderstanding** quickly became an argument.

一場**小誤會**很快演變成爭吵。

MCQ-ready definition:

minor misunderstanding = 後果不嚴重、較容易澄清的誤會

20. **common misunderstanding** — 常見誤解

This sense often refers to an incorrect belief shared by many people.

Practice 1

> It's a **common misunderstanding** that these two words mean exactly the same thing.

很多人**誤以為**這兩個字意思完全相同。

Practice 2

> There is a **common misunderstanding** about how the system works.

很多人對這個系統的運作方式存在**常見誤解**。

MCQ-ready definition:

common misunderstanding = 很多人都持有的錯誤理解或錯誤觀念

Important distinction 1: **misunderstanding** vs **mistake**

misunderstanding

the mistake is specifically in **understanding**.

mistake

any kind of error.

Kevin's mistake was caused by a misunderstanding, but not every mistake is a misunderstanding.

Important distinction 2: **misunderstanding vs confusion**

confusion

you are unclear or uncertain.

misunderstanding

you think you understand, but your understanding is wrong.

Example:

> "I don't know which file is yours."

> = confusion

> "Your file isn't there." when it actually is

> = misunderstanding

Very important distinction.

Important distinction 3: **misunderstanding vs disagreement**

misunderstanding

people understand facts/meaning differently because something was misinterpreted.

disagreement

people understand each other but hold different opinions.

> "I thought you said Friday."

> = misunderstanding

> "I know you prefer Friday, but I prefer Monday."

> = disagreement

Important distinction 4: **misunderstanding vs miscommunication**

misunderstanding

focuses on the **wrong understanding**.

miscommunication

focuses on the **communication process failing**.

Poor communication may cause a misunderstanding.

Important distinction 5: **misunderstanding vs assumption**

assumption

belief accepted without proof.

misunderstanding

wrong interpretation.

Kevin made an assumption because of a misunderstanding about the file.

The two can overlap but are not identical.

Important distinction 6: **misunderstand vs not understand**

not understand

you do not grasp the meaning.

misunderstand

you grasp it **incorrectly**.

> I don't understand what he means.

我不明白他的意思。

> I misunderstood what he meant.

我理解錯了他的意思。

Huge learner distinction.

Important distinction 7: **misunderstood vs confused**

I was misunderstood

other people understood **me** wrongly.

I was confused

I did not understand clearly.

Different direction.

Important distinction 8: **misunderstood vs misheard**

misheard

heard the sounds/words incorrectly.

misunderstood

understood the meaning incorrectly.

You can hear every word correctly and still misunderstand the meaning.

Important distinction 9: **clear up vs clear a misunderstanding**

The idiomatic phrase is:

> **clear up a misunderstanding**

= 澄清誤會

Clear the misunderstanding is possible in some contexts, but **clear up** is the more natural learner collocation.

Important distinction 10: ****resolve vs clear up a misunderstanding****

****clear up****

make the facts/meaning clear.

****resolve****

solve the resulting problem or conflict.

A conversation may both:

- * clear up the misunderstanding,
- * resolve the tension.

Important distinction 11: ****misunderstanding about vs misunderstanding between****

****about X****

topic misunderstood:

> misunderstanding about the deadline

對截止日期的誤解

****between A and B****

people involved:

> misunderstanding between Kevin and me

Kevin 和我之間的誤會

Important distinction 12: ****a misunderstanding vs misunderstanding as a general process****

Usually countable when referring to one incident:

> a misunderstanding

一場誤會

Plural:

> misunderstandings happen

誤會會發生

It can also appear more abstractly in phrases like:

> avoid misunderstanding

避免誤解

Family-extension note

The ****misunderstand**** family has one very stable semantic core:

****understand something in the wrong way****

That branches into:

1. ****verb****

- * misunderstand someone
- * misunderstand a situation
- * misunderstand what someone means

2. ****passive/adjective****

- * be misunderstood
- * misunderstood person

3. ****noun: incorrect interpretation****

- * a misunderstanding
- * common misunderstanding

4. ****noun: resulting interpersonal problem****

- * misunderstanding between friends
- * clear up a misunderstanding

For your passage, both noun layers are active:

wrong understanding of the file situation

which then causes

interpersonal tension between Kevin and the narrator

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
-----	-----	-----
misunderstand	誤解；誤會	understand wrongly
misunderstand someone	誤解某人	wrong interpretation of person
misunderstand what someone means	誤解某人的意思	wrong meaning
completely misunderstand	完全誤解	very wrong understanding
be misunderstood	被誤解	others understand wrongly
misunderstood (adj.)	被誤解的	not properly understood
misunderstanding	誤會；誤解	wrong understanding
misunderstanding between A and B	A 和 B 之間的誤會	interpersonal
misunderstanding about X	對 X 的誤解	topic
simple misunderstanding	單純誤會	straightforward error
minor misunderstanding	小誤會	limited consequence
serious misunderstanding	嚴重誤會	major consequence
common misunderstanding	常見誤解	widespread false belief
clear up a misunderstanding	澄清誤會	correct wrong understanding
avoid misunderstanding	避免誤解	prevent
cause a misunderstanding	造成誤會	produce wrong understanding
due to a misunderstanding	因為誤會	cause
Don't misunderstand me	別誤會我的意思	clarify intent
if I've misunderstood	如果我理解錯了	acknowledge possibility

For your original sentence

> When people are under pressure, **misunderstandings can happen in the blink of an eye**...

Here:

misunderstanding = 某人對事實或另一人的行為作出了錯誤理解，並可能因此造成關係上的不快

Kevin's chain was essentially:

- > He opened the wrong file
- > → thought the speaker had not uploaded their work
- > → assumed the speaker was delaying everyone
- > → publicly blamed them

So the ****misunderstanding**** began as a factual error but quickly became an interpersonal problem.

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

- > 當人處於壓力之下時，****誤會可以在一瞬間發生****。

For MCQ purposes, the cleanest contextual definition is:

****misunderstanding = an incorrect understanding of a situation, message, or person's intention
— 對情況、訊息或他人意圖的錯誤理解****